

FAMILY PLANNING METHODS GUIDE

Introduction

This guide provides an overview of family planning methods, including how they are used, advantages, possible side effects, counselling notes and cautions. It is based on the supplied Family Planning Method Reference Guide database content and is intended for education and counselling support.

MALE CONDOM

The male condom is a single-use barrier method used for contraception and STI/HIV risk reduction when used correctly and consistently. A new condom should be used for every act of sex, checked for package integrity and expiry, used from start to finish, and disposed after one use.

Advantages:

- STI/HIV risk reduction
- No hormones
- No procedure required

Side effects:

- Local irritation (occasional)
- Slippage or breakage (uncommon)

Caution:

- Do not reuse condoms.

FEMALE/INTERNAL CONDOM

The female/internal condom is a user-controlled barrier method inserted before sex and used once.

Advantages:

- User-controlled
- No hormones
- STI/HIV risk reduction

Side effects:

- Local discomfort (occasional)
- Slippage (uncommon)

Caution:

- Do not use an internal and external condom together.

COMBINED ORAL CONTRACEPTIVE PILL (COC)

The combined oral contraceptive pill is a short-acting hormonal method taken daily according to the pack schedule.

Advantages:

- Reversible
- User-controlled
- May make bleeding more predictable

Side effects:

- Nausea (common)
- Breast tenderness (common)
- Breakthrough bleeding (common)

Caution:

- Estrogen-containing methods are not suitable for everyone; eligibility assessment is required.

PROGESTIN-ONLY PILL (POP)

The progestin-only pill is a reversible estrogen-free oral contraceptive taken daily.

Advantages:

- Estrogen-free option
- Reversible
- No procedure

Side effects:

- Irregular bleeding (common)
- Headache (occasional)

Caution:

- Timing and adherence matter; follow current guidance.

DMPA INJECTABLE

DMPA is an injectable hormonal method providing several months of protection per dose.

Advantages:

- No daily action
- Discreet
- Reversible

Side effects:

- Irregular bleeding (common)
- Amenorrhea (common)
- Weight change (occasional)

Caution:

- Repeat dosing should follow current guidance.

NET-EN INJECTABLE

NET-EN is a reversible injectable method requiring repeat injections.

Advantages:

- No daily action
- Reversible
- Discreet

Side effects:

- Irregular bleeding (common)

- Injection-site discomfort (occasional)

Caution:

- Repeat injections are required on schedule.

3-YEAR AND 5-YEAR CONTRACEPTIVE IMPLANTS

Implants are hormonal, long-acting reversible methods inserted under the upper-arm skin by a trained provider.

Advantages:

- Long-acting
- Highly effective
- Reversible

Side effects:

- Irregular bleeding (common)
- Headache (occasional)
- Insertion-site discomfort (occasional)

Caution:

- Insertion and removal require a trained provider.

COPPER IUD

The Copper IUD is a hormone-free, long-acting reversible method inserted into the uterus.

Advantages:

- Long-acting
- Hormone-free
- Reversible

Side effects:

- Heavier menstrual bleeding (common)
- Cramping (common)

Caution:

- Requires clinical assessment and trained insertion/removal.

LEVONORGESTREL INTRAUTERINE SYSTEM (LNG-IUS)

The LNG-IUS is a long-acting hormonal intrauterine method.

Advantages:

- Long-acting
- Reversible
- May reduce bleeding

Side effects:

- Irregular bleeding (common)
- Amenorrhea (common)
- Cramping after insertion (occasional)

Caution:

- Requires clinical assessment and trained insertion/removal.

EMERGENCY CONTRACEPTIVE PILL

Emergency contraception is used after unprotected sex or contraceptive failure and is not intended as a regular ongoing method.

Advantages:

- Useful after contraceptive failure
- Easy to use

Side effects:

- Nausea (occasional)
- Temporary menstrual changes (common)

Caution:

- Not a regular ongoing family planning method.

LACTATIONAL AMENORRHEA METHOD (LAM)

LAM is a temporary postpartum method that requires all eligibility criteria to be met.

Advantages:

- No medicine
- No device

Side effects:

- No side-effect records are listed in the database.

Caution:

- Effectiveness depends on meeting all LAM criteria.

FERTILITY AWARENESS METHODS

These methods involve tracking fertility signs or cycle timing.

Advantages:

- Non-hormonal
- User-controlled

Side effects:

- No side-effect records are listed in the database.

Caution:

- Requires consistent tracking and cooperation.

FEMALE STERILIZATION/TUBAL LIGATION

Female sterilization is a permanent contraceptive method performed surgically after informed consent.

Advantages:

- Permanent

- Highly effective
- No ongoing supplies

Side effects:

- Post-procedure pain (occasional)
- Surgical complications (uncommon)

Caution:

- Intended to be permanent; counselling must cover alternatives and permanence.

GENERAL COUNSELLING MESSAGE

Individuals should receive informed counselling to select a method that matches their needs, preferences and circumstances. Some methods require trained healthcare providers for insertion, administration or removal.